the cult of personality.

According to the Resolution, Xi Jinping's theoretical contributions are put on par with those of Mao and Deng. They are described as the 'Marxism of contemporary China and of the 21st century'. [11] His pre-eminence in the Party is affirmed. He is described as the 'core' of the Party leadership. While the latest Resolution does not repudiate the earlier versions of 1945 and 1981, it contains harsh criticism of some of the negative trends seen in the CPC and society since the adoption of the Reform and Opening-Up Policy of Deng Xiaoping. These trends include 'a startling level of corruption', a 'blatant culture of pointless formalities, bureaucratism, hedonism and extravagance and a prevalence of privilege seeking attitudes and behaviour'. [12] On the ideological front, there is a strong warning to 'remain on guard against the erosive [sic] influence of Western trends of political thought, including the so-called constitutionalism, alternation of power between political parties and separation of powers'. [13]

On defence, the Resolution emphatically asserts Party leadership over the military, implicitly criticizing earlier regimes for weakening Party leadership over the military. The Resolution reaffirms the policy of deepening Reform and Opening-Up, stating that 'the Central Committee is keenly aware that opening the door brings progress while closing it leaves one behind'. [14] However, economic policy has been altered to accord a dominant role to state-owned enterprises, emphasizing the primacy of the domestic market vis-à-vis the external market, and prioritizing self-reliance in science and technology as 'the strategic pillar for the country's development'. [15]

While celebrating China's economic success and its increasingly influential role in the world, there is a parallel and even acute sense of insecurity born out of a perception of a hostile world outside its borders. This is reflected in the following section relating to national security:

> The Central Committee is acutely aware that confronted with various types of external encirclement, suppression, disruption and subversion, we must not be misguided or intimidated and we must fight to the end with any forces that would attempt to subvert the leadership of the CPC and China's socialist system or to hinder or obstruct China's advance towards national